

大学英语读写教程（二）、大学英语视听说教程（二）

复习材料

Reading Comprehension

Directions: Fill in the blanks by selecting suitable words from the word bank. You may not use any of the words more than once.

Banked Cloze 1

A. absorbed B. abundant C. accurate D. adjusted E. beneficial
F. bulk G. distress H. efficiently I. evidently J. fictions
K. functions L. hidden M. obliged N. official O. written

The Internet has made learning English much easier. English learners used to be 1)_____ to spend their time in libraries looking for the books that would help them in their language learning. It was very inconvenient because a lot of materials were 2)_____ in numerous textbooks and readers. But today content on a variety of subjects is only a click away. This is especially 3)_____ for those who are serious about learning English.

In order to achieve fluency in English, you need to be comfortable using at least 10,000 words. The 4)_____ materials on the Internet make it possible for you to choose appropriate content to read and listen to. These materials can be 5)_____ to your level if you input some keywords in the search engine. But how can you remember the 6)_____ of unfamiliar words?

In this case, the Internet 7)_____ makes it easier for you to learn vocabulary. You can use online dictionaries to instantly find out the specific meanings and grammatical 8)_____ of new words. The Internet helps you 9)_____ build up your vocabulary based on lively and interesting language content, which greatly reduces the 10)_____ caused by your inability to remember the new words. The efficiency of this vocabulary learning is one of the reasons why the Internet has become an ideal place to learn the English language.

参考答案:

M. obliged L. hidden E. beneficial B. abundant D. adjusted
F. bulk I. evidently K. functions H. efficiently G. distress

Banked Cloze 2

A. abilities B. absorbed C. competent D. confine E. confirm
F. fortunate G. gain H. generally I. inevitably J. obsesse

K. options L. passionate M. portions N. reputable O. resort

When choosing a college or major, you need to examine yourself: What are your 1) _____ and strengths? What are your weaknesses? What do you want out of life? Are you socially 2) _____ or do you need family and friends' support in order to 3) _____ what you have decided is right?

Your college does not have to be bigger than your high school. Don't be 4) _____ with the size of your college. Since a smaller community is more favorable for self-exploration, many 5) _____ colleges have a smaller student population. It is not the number of people, but the people themselves and the kind of school community in which you will learn that really matter.

You don't have to 6) _____ to other people's help, but think about the people in your life who are happy and successful and find out where they went to college. You will 7) _____ find that success in life has less to do with the choice of college than with the experience and opportunities you'll 8) _____ while in college, coupled with personal qualities and traits.

There are many 9) _____ to major in, but you may need the variety and depth of college coursework to determine the major you are 10) _____ about. Whether you choose your major out of personal interest or for the needs of society and the country, you may possibly change your mind, even two or three times, before you finally settle on one.

参考答案:

A. abilities C. competent E. confirm J. obsessed N. reputable
O. resort I. inevitably G. gain K. options L. passionate

Banked Cloze 3

A. academic B. asserting C. assuming D. dynamic E. emerge
F. ethic G. innovated H. motivated I. obey J. obsess
K. persevering L. platform M. released N. remained O. retain

Ms. Wang has been happy with her new job with a software company. "It offers a big 1) _____ for me to develop, and I can learn much!" she said. Like Ms. Wang, a growing number of young Chinese workers are demanding that their voices be heard and 2) _____ themselves more in the workplace. Young people have become the main population in China's talent market, according to a report 3) _____ earlier this year. Therefore, many companies are doubling their efforts to attract and 4) _____ this vital group.

Raised in the time of great social and economic change in China, this generation has 5) _____ as well-educated, highly resourceful members of the workforce. They are often in search of better learning and career-development opportunities. A study of the generation found that of employees who 6) _____ with the same company for one to five years, more than 80 percent said that good

career development was what 7)_____ them to stay with the company.
This generation doesn't just want to 8)_____ orders. They want to participate in decision-making.
They question authority and are 9)_____ in what they're pursuing. If companies want to keep on
these talented employees, they have to make the workplace more 10)_____. Many companies
have taken significant steps to create more flexible working environments, in an attempt to
encourage employees to stay longer with the company.

参考答案:

L. platform B. asserting M. released O. retain E. emerged
N. remained H. motivated I. obey K. persevering D. dynamic

Banked Cloze 4

A. absolutely B. adequately C. aspirations D. compelling E. detect
F. dictate G. geophysics H. imaginary I. inspirations J. platforms
K. process L. prosperous M. rejuvenate N. significant O. tedious

Dear students,

My field falls within basic science research – the mobile platform detection technology. As an
important research field of 1)_____, this technology is absolutely challenging. My work aims to
develop mobile 2)_____ for ships and vehicles, use geophysical detection equipment and
technology to 3)_____ multi-information, based on which to build models, and provide technical
support for energy and mineral resources exploration. This technology can clearly
4)_____ what's down there two kilometers or more below the ground.

As China becomes a stronger and more 5)_____ nation, it needs many people who have studied
abroad to return to the motherland and help with its modernization. I hope that we can together make
6)_____ contributions to the development of China's science and technology.

As the representative of your teachers, I would like to say that no matter whether your
7)_____ lead you to success or failure, no matter whether you are doing fine or not, and no matter
whether your life is 8)_____ or boring, you will always be in our mind because we care about
you. As you are about to graduate from college and join in efforts to 9)_____ our nation, we'll
share the responsibilities and happiness with you.

How time flies! I still remember the time when I was standing where you are now. It's
10)_____ my pleasure to come back to my alma mater after I graduated 18 years ago. No matter
how many ups and downs you'll go through, I hope you can remember our college and return as
often as you can. We'll cheer you on! Go! Go!

参考答案:

G. geophysics J. platforms K. process E. detect L. prosperous
N. significant C. aspirations D. compelling M. rejuvenate A. absolutely

Banked Cloze 5

A. appetites B. dilemma C. engage D. explicit E. explosive
F. manage G. manipulated H. objectives I. particular J. perspectives
K. regulated L. retain M. suspend N. sustain O. urgent

To spend or save is a question which many people have in their mind. They are always in a(n) 1)_____ whether they should spend the money that they have earned or save that money for the future. Well, there is no 2)_____ answer to the question as different people have different 3)_____ on life, and that is the reason why some people tend to spend all their money while others 4)_____ control over their money.

People who spend all their money do not think much about the future. What they enjoy doing is to get pleasure from spending money. For example, if they like a(n) 5)_____ car, mobile phone, or laptop, they will buy it without giving it a second thought. For them, the most important thing is to satisfy their growing material 6)_____.

In the long run, saving helps people 7)_____ their personal finances as saving helps an individual better plan for future 8)_____ needs. From our everyday life, we can see that individuals who can 9)_____ their spending save money successfully. Instead of buying things on impulse, they delay their purchasing decision and are not easily 10)_____ by commercial ads. Individuals who have responsibility for their family or their loved ones often belong to this group.

参考答案:

B. dilemma D. explicit J. perspectives L. retain I. particular
A. appetites F. manage O. urgent M. suspend G. manipulated

Banked Cloze 6

A. agenda B. deserve C. discarded D. disproved E. implement
F. impulsive G. modify H. motivate I. notify J. passive
K. preserve L. proclaims M. profits N. revolve O. sensible

Being simple is not necessarily about having less. It can be about having more: more time, more enjoyment, more accomplishment, and more of what 1)_____ you. If some activities don't bring you any benefits, doing less or none of them makes sense, because it may eventually do harm to you to 2)_____ all of them. The purpose of being simple is to remove what's not important.

To understand what should be 3)_____, try to think of activities as either assets or "obligations". An asset is something that is valuable. One 4)_____ example is learning to manage your money. A little more broadly, an asset is anything that can strengthen and 5)_____ you, moving you closer to your goals. However, the "obligations" are a kind of 6)_____ debt, anything that weakens you, moves you farther from your goals, provides negative stress, and creates anxiety. Then how can you 7)_____ the idea of being simple? Think about your daily activities and set a(n) 8)_____. You list your daily routines such as paying bills and planning a birthday party for a friend. Don't just 9)_____ around your hobbies. Ask yourself if the activities get you closer to your goals. If not, 10)_____ the list – remove what is unnecessary and concentrate on what is more important for you.

参考答案:

M. profits K. preserve C. discarded O. sensible H. motivate
F. massive E. implement A. agenda N. resolve G. modify

Directions: Translate the following paragraph into Chinese.

Passage 1

English is known as a world language, regularly used by many nations for whom English is not their first language. Like other languages, English has changed greatly. The history of the English language can be divided into three main periods: Old English, Middle English, and Modern English. The English language started with the invasion of Britain by three Germanic tribes during the 5th century AD, and they contributed greatly to the formation of the English language. During the medieval and early modern periods, the influence of English spread throughout the British Isles, and from the early 17th century, its influence began to be felt throughout the world. The processes of European exploration and colonization for several centuries led to significant change in English. Today, American English is particularly influential due to the popularity of American cinema, television, music, trade, and technology, including the Internet.

英语被认为是一种世界语言，经常被许多不以英语为第一语言的国家使用。与其他语言一样，英语也发生了很大的变化。英语的历史可以分为三个主要阶段：古英语、中古英语和现代英语。英语起源于公元 5 世纪，当时三个日耳曼部落

入侵英国，他们对英语语言的形成起了很大的作用。在中世纪和现代社会初期，英语的影响遍及不列颠群岛。从 17 世纪初，它的影响力开始在世界各地显现。欧洲几百年的探险和殖民过程导致了英语的重大变化。今天，由于美国电影、电视、音乐、贸易和技术（包括互联网）的流行，美国英语的影响力尤其显著。

Passage 2

Being at college is a transformative experience. While you are changing, so are your aspirations and interests. If you are considering switching majors, there's nothing wrong with it – in fact, it may mean that you've gained more insight into who you are and what you enjoy doing. When you initially chose your major, you were likely between the ages of 17 and 19, a time when your brain hadn't fully developed!

Attending college is a great way to expose yourself to outside opportunities in which you may have had a limited view from where you grew up, and this may help you discover what you truly want to do. Thus, the idea of switching your major is a positive sign of growth and development and maybe a positive change on your academic path.

读大学可以给人带来巨大的改变。随着你的成长，你的志向和兴趣也会发生改变。所以，如果你正在考虑转专业，这不仅没有什么错——事实上，这可能意味着你对自己以及你喜欢做的事情有了更深入的了解。毕竟你在最初选专业时候可能只有 18 岁左右，那时你的大脑甚至还没有完全发育成熟。

上大学是让自己接触到外界机会的一种绝佳途径，这些机会可能在你成长的环境当中并不常见。而这些机会可能会帮助你发现你真正想做的事情。因而，转专业的想法可以代表着你的成长和进步，同时也有可能是你学术道路上的一个重要转折点。

Passage 3

Many young people today reject the idea of having only one main interest. Known as slash youths (斜杠青年), they prefer not to be limited to a single identity. Their attitudes have been shaped by social media, which emphasizes personal identity, and their fondness for entrepreneurship.

That shift in mindset could change the future of work. As free agents, they are not satisfied with committing to a single organization or traditional full-time employment. Instead, the members of the slash generation usually have day jobs to pay their bills but also invest time and energy in other pursuits that allow them to express themselves creatively, pursue personal values, and maintain their well-being.

现如今，许多年轻人并不赞同只能有一个主要兴趣的观念。被称为“斜杠青年”的他们更倾向于拥有多元化的身份。社交媒体强调个人的独特性，加之他们对创业的喜好，共同塑造了他们的态度。

这种心态的转变可能会改变未来的工作模式。作为自由的个体，他们不满足于只投身于一家机构或传统的全职工作。相反，斜杠青年通常有一份正职来支付生活开支，但也投入时间和精力去追求其他让他们能够实现创造力、追寻个人价值并保持幸福感的事业。

Passage 4

Guochao, also known as Chinese trends or "China chic (时尚)", expresses the rise of China's native fashion trends. With the growing popularity of Chinese trends, more young people are paying attention to traditional Chinese art and literature, including ancient musical instruments, dancing, and clothes. Among them, numerous artists have attempted to demonstrate traditional Chinese culture in innovative ways, for instance, creating underwater classical dancing performances or adding classical Chinese elements to fondant (翻糖) cakes. With the help of popular video platforms, they are able to reach wider audiences and effectively promote Chinese fashion to the public with their drive and passion.

“国潮”，又称“中国潮流”或“中国时尚”，代表着中国本土时尚潮流的崛起。随着国潮越来越受欢迎，越来越多的年轻人开始关注中国传统艺术和文学，包括古代乐器、舞蹈和服装。其中，许多艺术家尝试以创新的方式来展示中国传统文化。例如，创造水中古典舞蹈表演或在翻糖蛋糕中加入中国古典元素。借助流行

的视频平台，他们能够触达更广泛的观众群体，并以他们的动力和热情有效地向公众推广中国时尚。

Passage 5

If you've ever heard someone say they're going to go thrifting, you might be wondering what they mean. Simply put, thrifting means going shopping at a thrift store (廉价旧货店), garage sale, or flea (跳蚤) market where you'll find gently used items at discounted prices. These items have been loved by a previous owner but are usually in good shape and can serve a new owner for years to come.

Shopping at a thrift store can be exciting, as you never know what treasures you may find. Most people who shop at thrift stores are creative and enjoy the surprise of the hunt. They can see the potential in items that others may have overlooked and give new life to these items. For example, clothing at a thrift store may not necessarily be in-season, but those who buy clothes there are able to get creative and express their own personal style in a way that is relevant to what's in-season.

如果你听到有人说要去“淘衣服”，你可能会想知道他们在说什么。简单来说，“淘衣服”是指去二手商店、旧货市场或跳蚤市场购物，在那里你可以以折扣价购买到轻度使用过的物品。这些物品一直受到前主人的喜爱，但通常情况下，它们的状态良好，还可以供新主人使用多年。

在二手店购物会令人兴奋，因为你永远不知道你会找到什么宝藏。大多数在二手店购物的人都富有创造力，并喜欢寻宝中的惊喜。他们能从旧物中发现别人可能忽略的物品潜力，会为这些旧物赋予新的生命。例如，二手商店的服装不一定是时下流行的款式，但在二手商店购买服装的人能够发挥创意，将其穿出个性化的时尚风格。

Passage 6

The minimalist (极简主义的) lifestyle goes beyond simply getting rid of material possessions. It's rooted in the pursuit of a fulfilling life centered on the intangible things

money can't buy. Minimalism (极简主义) frees you from the unnecessary clutter of material items so you can focus on what truly matters – family, friends, education, and more.

The ultimate goal of minimalism is to find lasting happiness and fulfillment in life. Unfortunately, many believe that having an expensive car, a beautiful wardrobe, or a job with an impressive title will bring them lasting happiness and satisfaction. However, happiness and contentment reside in the present and can't be bought. They must be worked for and earned in the present moment with mindfulness and good intentions. By living a minimalist lifestyle, one can shift their mindset to prioritize what's truly significant over short-term satisfaction from material possessions.

极简主义的生活方式不仅仅是摆脱物质财富。它植根于对充实生活的追求，这种生活看重的是用金钱买不到的、无形的事物。极简主义可以帮你从乱七八糟的非必需品中解脱出来，这样你就可以专注于真正重要的事情，比如家庭、朋友、教育等等。

极简主义的最终目标是在生活中找到持久的幸福和满足。不幸的是，许多人认为，拥有昂贵的汽车、漂亮的衣柜或头衔令人印象深刻的工作会给他们带来持久的幸福和满足。然而，幸福和满足存在于当下，是买不到的。人们必须在当下的时刻通过正念和善意来努力获得它们。通过过上极简主义的生活方式，人们的思维模式会相应地发生转变，不再在意物质财富带来的短期满足感，而是更加关注真正重要的事情。

Directions: Translate the following sentences into English.

Unit 1

- 1 众所周知，中国书法（calligraphy）是一门独特的艺术，也是世界上独一无二的艺术瑰宝（treasure）。

As is known to all, Chinese calligraphy is a unique art and also an art treasure valued by the world.

- 2 汉字在漫长的演变过程中，始终起着交流思想、传承文化的重要作用。

In the long process of evolution, Chinese characters have always been playing an important role in exchanging ideas and inheriting culture.

- 3 很显然，中国书法的形成、发展与汉字的演变存在着密不可分的关系。

Apparently, the formation and development of Chinese calligraphy are closely related to (associated with / connected to / linked with) the evolution of Chinese characters.

Unit 2

- 1 改革开放以来，中国的教育事业得到了快速发展，并取得了引人瞩目的成就。

Since the reform and opening up, China's education has developed rapidly and made remarkable achievements.

- 2 中国的教育成就主要反映在九年义务教育（nine-year compulsory education）的全面普及（popularization）和高等教育大众化的实现等多个方面。

China's achievements in education are reflected in various aspects, including the popularization of nine-year compulsory education and the realization of mass higher education.

- 3 我们将深入实施科教兴国（invigorating China through science and education）战略，坚持教育优先发展，为党育人、为国育才，全面提高人才自主培养质量。

We will fully implement the strategy for invigorating China through science and education, continue to give high priority to the development of education, cultivate talent for the Party and the country, and comprehensively improve our ability to nurture talent at home.

Unit 3

- 1 如今,很多年轻人不再只选择稳定的 (stable) 工作, 他们更愿意自主创业, 依靠自己的智慧和努力去证明他们的自我价值 (self-worth)。

Nowadays, many young people no longer choose stable jobs only; they are more willing to start their own business and prove their self-worth with their own wisdom and efforts.

- 2 创业者的成功不但会创造财富, 增加就业机会, 改善大家的生活, 而且从长远来看, 对于我们的国家也是一件好事。

The success of entrepreneurs not only makes a fortune, increases job opportunities, and improves people's lives, but it also benefits (is also beneficial to) our country in the long run.

- 3 中国政府大力鼓励和支持创业和创新, 这会进一步激发年轻人的热情, 增强他们的信心。

The Chinese government strongly encourages and supports entrepreneurship and innovation, which further fuels young people's passions and enhances their confidence.

Unit 4

- 1 丝绸之路 (the Silk Road) 是中国古代的交通线路网络, 也是中国最早用于国际贸易和文化交流的渠道。

The Silk Road was an ancient network of transportation routes starting from China; it was also China's earliest channel for international trade and cultural exchanges.

- 2 在古代, 丝绸之路有效地促进了各国之间经济文化的交流, 从而大大推动了世

界文明的进程。

In ancient times, the Silk Road effectively promoted economic and cultural exchanges between countries, thereby greatly pushing the progress of the world civilization.

- 3 在新的历史条件下,中国提出了以合作共赢为核心的“一带一路”倡议(the Belt and Road Initiative), 得到了沿线各国的积极响应。

In the new historical situation, China proposed (put forward) the Belt and Road Initiative with win-win cooperation as the core, which has received positive responses from the countries along the routes.

Unit 5

- 1 中庸思想 (Doctrine of the Mean) 是儒家思想的核心之一,“中”不是折中,而是处理事情时的一种适度的 (moderate) 方法。

The Doctrine of the Mean is one of the core ideas of Confucianism; the “mean” doesn’t refer to “compromise” but to a moderate way to handle things.

- 2 孔子主张,应该通过自身修养(self-cultivation)把中庸思想融入日常行为中,使之成为一种美德。

Confucius advocated that the Doctrine of the Mean should be integrated into one’s daily conduct by way of self-cultivation and seen as a virtue.

- 3 一直以来,中庸思想为民族精神的构建、智慧的传播和文化的发展发挥着不可估量的 (immeasurable) 作用。

The Doctrine of the Mean has been playing an immeasurable role in the construction of the national spirit, the transmission of wisdom, and the development of culture.

Unit 6

- 1 国民幸福指数（Gross National Happiness Index）用以衡量人们的幸福感，还能反映一个国家或地区的经济发展水平和居民生活水平。

The Gross National Happiness Index (GNH Index) is used to measure people's happiness, and it also reflects the economic development level and people's living standards of a country or region.

- 2 随着中国经济的高速增长，中国政府越来越重视人民群众的生活质量和国民幸福指数。

With the rapid growth of China's economy, the Chinese government is paying more and more attention to people's quality of life and the GNH Index.

- 3 不断改善人民群众的生活条件，让他们得到更多实惠，将促进国民幸福指数不断提升。

The constant improvement in people's living conditions and the provision of more benefits will push a continuous rise in the GNH Index.

Possible Directions: Fill in the blanks with the words given below. Change the form where necessary. Each word can be used only once.

The great journey of learning

1 Malcolm X was an African-American civil rights activist, writer and speaker. Born in 1925, he was mysteriously assassinated in 1965. By the time of his death, his own telling of his life story, *The Autobiography of Malcolm X*, had been widely known. He was born Malcolm Little into a poor household. Later, he took the name Malcolm X

after joining an organization.

2 Malcolm X learned about the organization while in prison for committing criminal acts such as theft. Because he was poorly educated, he felt inadequate to share his new ideas with others. As a young man, he could sketch his thoughts with poor grammar and little vocabulary using the simple, unsophisticated language of people on the street. As an adult, when he tried to introduce his new ideas to others, he found that he didn't have the adequate communication skills he needed. In his own words, he "wasn't even functional".

3 In a bid to increase his knowledge and improve his skills, desperate Malcolm X devised a scheme. He turned to books, believing this would be beneficial. However, when he tried to read serious books on his own, he was distressed as he didn't know most of the words. To speed up his language learning scheme, he skipped all the words he didn't know and then would end up with no clue as to what the book was about. "I became frustrated," Malcolm X wrote in his autobiography, speaking of his inadequate language skills.

4 Malcolm X's considerable frustration at his inability to read and write launched him on a quest to overcome his deficiencies. He said, "I saw that the best thing I could do was get hold of a dictionary – to study, to learn some words." And he was also lucky enough to reason that he should try to improve his handwriting. "It was sad. I couldn't even write in a straight line," he told us. These ideas together moved him to appeal to the prison authorities for some paper and pencils.

5 For the first two days, Malcolm X just skimmed through the pages of the dictionary, trying to negotiate his way through its unfamiliar format. He told us of his amazement

at how closely related the words seemed – how *moist* could be the root of *moisture*, and how *advisable* and *advisory* had the same root! "I didn't know which words I needed to learn," he said. "Finally, just to start some kind of action, I began copying." In his slow, careful, and crude handwriting, Malcolm X copied everything on the first full page of the dictionary into a notebook. He even copied the quotation marks! This took him one full day. After that, he read everything he had written aloud. "Over and over, aloud, to myself, I read my own handwriting," Malcolm recalled. He also logged important things that happened every day. Repetition helped move him from basic literacy toward true proficiency.

6 Malcolm X depicted how, the next morning when he woke up, he kept thinking about the words he had copied and read aloud and about the acquisition of the knowledge he was pursuing. It was a marvellous feeling. He felt immensely proud.

7 He was so fascinated that he went on copying the next page of the dictionary. Once again, he awoke, proud and energized. With every succeeding page he copied and read aloud, Malcolm X found he was learning and remembering more and more words. With each successive day, his confusion diminished.

8 As Malcolm X's word base broadened, he began to better understand the books he read. It was the first time in his life this had ever happened. "Anyone who has read a great deal can imagine the new world that opened." From then until he left that prison, his concentration was focused on reading. He was so absorbed in it that months passed without his even thinking about being in prison. "In fact, up to then, I had never been so truly free in my life."

9 "I knew right there in prison that reading had changed forever the course of my life,"

Malcolm X wrote. He described how one day a writer telephoned him from London for an interview. The interviewer asked Malcolm X what college he had graduated from as he could write so fluently. He told the Englishman that his personal university was "books".

10 Malcolm X's life is a wonderful example of the profound effect of learning a language. He was born into a world full of poverty and ignorance. However, as he acquired knowledge, his horizons expanded. He had left behind the narrow, ignorant world of his youth to join the world community of thoughts and actions ever since he started with his great journey of learning in prison.

The humanities: out of date?

1 When the going gets tough, the tough take accounting. When the job market worsens, many students calculate they can't major in English or history. They have to study something that boosts their prospects of landing a job.

2 The data show that as students in the U.S. have increasingly shouldered the ever-rising cost of tuition, they have defected from the study of the humanities to applied science and "hard" skills that they bet will lead to employment. In other words, a college education is more and more seen as a means for economic betterment rather than a means for human betterment. This is a trend that is likely to persist and even accelerate.

3 Over the next few years, as labor markets struggle, the humanities will probably continue their long slide in succession. There already has been a nearly 50 percent decline in the portion of liberal arts majors over the past years, and it is logical to think that the trend is bound to continue or even accelerate. Once the dominant pillar of

university life, the humanities now play little roles when students take their college tours. These days, labs are more vivid and compelling than libraries.

4 Here, please allow me to stand up for and promote the true value that the humanities add to people's lives. Since ancient times, people have speculated about the mystery of those inner forces that drive some people to greatness and others to self-destruction. This inner drive has been called many things over the centuries. The famous psychologist, Sigmund Freud, called it the "unconscious mind" or, more familiarly, "instinct".

5 From the beginning of time, this inner aspect of our being, this drive that can be constructive or destructive, has captured our imagination. The stories of this amazing struggle have formed the basis of cultures the world over. Historians, architects, authors, philosophers, and artists have captured the words, images, and meanings of this inner struggle in the form of story, music, myth, painting, architecture, sculpture, landscape, and tradition. These men and women developed artistic "languages" that help us understand these aspirations and also educate generations. This vast body of work from ancient times, the very foundation of civilization, forms the basis of the study of the humanities.

6 Studying the humanities improves our ability to read and write. No matter what we do in life, we will have a huge advantage if we can read complex ideas and understand their meaning. Likewise, we will immensely benefit if we can write a clear and elegant analysis of those ideas.

7 Studying the humanities makes us familiar with the language of emotion and the creative process. In an information economy, many people have the ability to produce

a useful product. Yet, very few people have the ability to create a spectacular brand. Most importantly, studying the humanities invests us with great insight and self-awareness, thereby releasing our creative energy and talent in a positive and constructive manner.

8 Perhaps the best argument in favor of the humanities is the scope of possibilities that are widely open to us. Did you know that Sally Ride, the first American woman getting into space, had a degree in the humanities, aside from physics? Martial arts actor Bruce Lee also majored in the humanities. Famous people who studied the humanities make a long list. It's easy to see that the humanities can prepare us for many different careers and jobs we can undertake, whether medicine, business, science, or entertainment. If we study only mathematics, it's likely we will be a candidate only for jobs as a mathematician. If we include studying the humanities, we can break through many barriers and are limited only by our effort and imagination.

9 Of course, nowadays, if we study the humanities alone, we are liable to miss many opportunities. Each one of us needs to become as technically and professionally skilled as possible to meet the needs of modern life. In fact, increasingly a pairing of technical knowledge and inner insight is seen as the ideal in the establishment of a career. If I were the Dean of Admissions at a medical school and two people applied to our school, both having the required basic science courses, one a philosophy major and the other solely a pre-med student, the philosophy applicant would be chosen.

10 In summary, the humanities help to create well-rounded human beings with insight and understanding of the passions, hopes, and dreams common to all humanity. The humanities, the ancient timeless reservoir of knowledge, teach us to see things

differently and broaden our horizons. They are as useful and relevant in our modern age as they have always been. Doesn't it make sense to spend some time in the company of the humanities, our outstanding and remarkable treasure of knowledge?

Understanding the young generation

1 Today's young generation simply can't imagine a world without the Internet or cell phones. They are gifted with technology and crazy about artificial intelligence. However, this is just one of their unique characteristics. They are also known as a generation that is visual, idealistic, and global. Society has been making little noises about this particular group, throwing criticism along their way to maturity. No matter whether these noises are valid or not, to fully tap into their strengths and resourcefulness, we need to be patient, communicative, and understanding.

2 To start with, we must be patient with the young generation, or some unexpected incidents may occur. Occasionally, we do see some young people who are not considerate of others. The following anecdote may, in a way, serve as proof and illustrate this characteristic some young people possess.

3 Staying at our cottage recently, my husband and I were joined by my 20-year-old niece and her three best buddies for four days. We listened a lot to their dreams and schemes, as well as their self-evaluations. We were so amazed at their perceptive views, their broad knowledge of the world, and their impressive capability to use their cell phones.

4 The young ladies decided to have a beach fire and spent the evening chatting and renewing friendships. They undoubtedly had a lot of fun at the beach that night, but the

next day, when my husband tried to build a fire for me, gosh, he discovered, rather than dragging fire logs to the beach, the girls had burned every piece of kindling in the garage – something he had spent two days splitting logs to create!

5 Though a little offended, my husband didn't complain at all. Looking at these cheerful young ladies, he whispered in my ear, "You know they were born and grew up in an entirely different world from ours, so we should be patient enough toward their behavior. I believe they'll become more mature and considerate later on." He's right. Being patient is the best strategy for helping young people grow.

6 Effective communication is also a key to the solution of an unpleasant occurrence. Sometimes, people criticize young people's "individualism", condemning their self-centered behavior. Is that true? Yeah, sometimes. But be aware, that's exactly the time when communication is needed. From an incident that is illustrative of this characteristic, we can infer there must be a communication breakdown.

7 Not long ago, we held a barbecue to celebrate a product launch. Employees ordered one of three entrées in advance. Guess what? The first employees in the line, primarily hungry young men, helped themselves to as many entrées as they wanted – some took all three. Consequently, the caterer ran out of food before all of our employees could eat. My husband and I, who usually wait until we are sure all of the employees get food, ended up eating at a local restaurant. So did many of our employees who missed out on the meal.

8 This episode seems anything but incidental. Did these young individuals ever think about the possible consequences that might impact others? In this story, no. Then the action is most likely impulsive. How can we avoid this kind of incident? The answer is

– better communication. A sign could have reminded the employees that they were assigned one entrée, the one they pre-ordered. Also, the caterer could have orally sent out the message that they could only take one or their co-workers would go hungry.

9 Last but not least, to work successfully with young people, older generations need to show more understanding. Unfortunately, the young generation is, on a large scale, depicted as a group that lacks self-awareness. It might be true, but ironically, sometimes older generations can have the same problem.

10 Just yesterday, an elderly employee reported to the HR office that the young employees on her team were committing age discrimination. Later, however, the HR manager found that they were actually having problems understanding each other. The elderly employee assumed that her great experience would be respected and her ideas would be implemented by the young employees. However, they somehow challenged her opinions and wanted to do the project in their own way.

11 To prevent an elevation of this conflict, the elderly employee, who was used to automatic respect and trust from people young enough to be her children and grandchildren, had to learn that whereas treating each other with mutual respect in the workplace is a must, expecting your ideas to be influential because you know more is not necessarily right. On the other hand, the young employees need to understand that they can't reject an idea without first weighing its merits.

12 To conclude, what this young generation expects from us is more patience, better communication, and deeper understanding. To retain these extremely talented young people at work, employers should be inspirational and able to recognize their priorities and immediate needs. Smart employers demonstrate not only IQ but also EQ – they

share knowledge and information yet understand emotion and networking. In this environment, young people will surely excel and make a commitment. Their real strengths and resourcefulness can, therefore, be successfully tapped.

The stories behind "Two Bombs and One Satellite"

1 On October 16, 1964, with a loud bang and a mushroom cloud of flames, the desert of Lop Nur in northwest China's Xinjiang Uygur Autonomous Region witnessed a new accomplishment for the Chinese people: the first detonation of a Chinese-made atomic bomb.

2 But it would not be the only great accomplishment that the nation achieved in the field of national defense. Since the founding of the People's Republic of China, bolstering the nation's defense has become a top priority. As a result, the "Two Bombs and One Satellite" project was launched. "Two Bombs" refers to the nuclear bombs (atomic and hydrogen bombs) and the missile, while "One Satellite" refers to the space satellite.

3 China first made history in missile technology on November 5, 1960, with the successful launch of its first short-range missile, *Dongfeng-1*. From that day onward, China has been moving forward in giant steps in missile technology.

4 The nation exploded its first hydrogen bomb on June 17, 1967, a feat achieved in less than three years after the advent of the atomic bomb. This established China as the fourth country worldwide to master hydrogen bomb technology. Remarkably, the time span between China's detonating the first atomic bomb and the first hydrogen bomb was the shortest among all countries, a testament to its scientific prowess.

5 Then on April 24, 1970, China launched its first space satellite, *Dongfanghong-1*.

This significant event not only made China the fifth country globally to independently develop and launch a satellite, but also symbolized the beginning of the nation's exploration of the universe and its peaceful use of outer space.

6 All these achievements demonstrated China's ability to overcome adversity, as they were all attained during a time when the nation faced a scarcity of resources. The success of the "Two Bombs and One Satellite" project laid the foundation for developing cutting-edge science and technology for China's national defense. During the process, numerous scientists devoted themselves to the cause and worked in anonymity for the final success. One scientist, in particular, was Deng Jiaxian, whose contributions were crucial to the development of China's atomic bomb and hydrogen bomb technologies.

7 In 1958, Deng Jiaxian, a talented young physicist, accepted a position in a highly confidential atomic bomb research program. This top-secret mission necessitated that researchers move and stay away from their families for many years. He said to his wife, "I will devote my life to the future work. If I complete this task, my life will have great meaning, and even if I die for it, it will be worth it."

8 After that, Deng vanished from the public eye, and he began his career as an anonymous atomic bomb specialist. Despite poor conditions, Deng's determination remained unyielding. As director of the research institute and leader of China's atomic bomb design, he gave lessons on atomic theory himself and organized people to translate and study relevant foreign language materials. He was always the first to take any risk. He insisted on being on the front line from the outset, being present for 32 of the total 45 experiments and serving as site commander for 15 of them.

9 In an experiment in 1979, a bomb fell directly to the ground without exploding. Despite the grave risk, Deng rushed to the impact site and took the bomb fragments into his own hands for careful examination. He put the interests of the nation before his own safety.

10 Though he fell ill, he continued working until 1985, when he could not ignore his symptoms any longer. On July 29, 1986, Deng passed away from cancer. Even in his final moments, he still had his heart set on the cutting-edge weapons research of his homeland, saying, "Don't let others leave us too far behind ..."

11 Deng worked diligently and anonymously for 28 years. People remained unaware of his efforts and innovations until June 1986, when his name suddenly appeared in all the major media reports across the country. It was in this year that his instrumental contributions finally came to light and his name was cemented in the history of China's national defense.

12 Deng's efforts and achievements are a credit to the nation and will never be forgotten. But it is also important to acknowledge that the success of the "Two Bombs and One Satellite" project was only possible through the joint efforts of many other anonymous workers and researchers. They, together, formed the backbone of our nation.

13 Living in the wilderness, they worked around the clock for the nation. These determined and resourceful people took every challenge in stride and did not seek recognition for their individual efforts. All they wanted was to contribute to our country. Their patriotism, dedication, self-reliance, hard work, and collaboration, as well as the courage to scale new heights in science and technology, are revered as the spirit of "Two Bombs and One Satellite". It, like a beacon, has led generations of scientists and

engineers to strive for new scientific advancements and unlock technological marvels that were once considered mere dreams.

A \$3,000 dictionary

1 I remember a day some years back, one of the first days of a new semester in college. People were tossing balls, passing out catalogs, and handing out free stuff. I was completely charmed by all the activity. After all, a major feature of college life in the U.S. is limited finances, so free stuff is like gold. As a college student, I felt entitled to my share!

2 I moved closer to scout out the situation. In my mind, I heard my mother issue her famous line: "There is no such thing as free stuff!", as the student behind the table urged me to receive a brand-new dictionary. My mom's voice was quickly filtered out as I reached out to claim my gift. I was handed a form instead. Once I completed the credit card application, I was told, I would receive a free dictionary. With the confidence that a probe of my finances would reveal the sheer weakness of my profile, I completed the form and submitted it.

3 To my sheer amazement, plastic freedom made its way into my mailbox a few weeks later. At first, I was shocked that these huge credit card corporations trusted me, a struggling student holding two minimum wage part-time jobs and paying monthly installments on a purchased computer. But the credit card company seemed to know more than I did, so I accepted the card and decided it was perfect to develop my own credit just as so many had done before me.

4 My first purchases were tame: a T-shirt, vitamins, or a CD, as if I hadn't had the card.

Soon, however, I began to buy things that I wanted. With my artificial sense of security, I bought a guitar, a fishing rod, long-stem roses for my girlfriend, a brand-new wardrobe, a sophisticated new calculator, and countless other trifles I felt I "absolutely needed". I began to accumulate debt.

5 Things got worse when I lost one part-time job and with it my funds grew even smaller, like those now long-dead roses. I began taking cash advances just to eat. There was barely enough money from my paychecks to cover basic ongoing living expenses, and satisfying the minimum monthly payment on the card was impossible. Now, the principal balance doubled due to late payment penalties and other sanctions that the credit card issuer imposed in accordance with the contract.

6 Usually, I'm not a person who takes things too seriously. I always see the positive side of negative situations, but the gravity of my credit card debt crisis had left me in despair. My parents provided the tuition for school, so I believed it was my responsibility to take care of everything else in my life. I owed them more than I could possibly imagine, specifically their vision of a boy becoming a truly autonomous man. Now, I was letting them, and myself, down. Every time my mom called to chat, she always asked if I needed money. I knew her heart would break if I had said "Yes", so I shrugged it off and hid everything from her.

7 I began to lose interest in many activities in which I'd become involved. Friends would call and invite me for dinner, but my finances would prohibit any expenses, so I'd decline every time. I would manufacture excuses for why I always said no to their offers. My dirty little secret began to tear at my emotional stability. Soon, calls from friends became more infrequent, meeting new people was out of the question, and my mom

began exclaiming she didn't know why she even bothered to call me. A simple matter of credit card debt caused me to drive everything I cared about from my life. I felt emotionally crippled and financially bankrupt!

8 After graduation, I finally explained my financial distress to my mother. It had been several years since my awful money issues began, so I believed the wound had been fairly well healed. However, the blend of disgust and embarrassment I felt when I explained my credit card debt was torture. I choked on every word, and I hesitated on the number. I felt physical pain when I looked her in the eye. There was nothing more terrifying to me than exemplifying a parent's nightmare. The time had come to move toward a solution. At that moment, I felt the negativity I had brought into my life began to dissolve.

9 Recently I learned that I'm not an isolated case, not the only college student to suffer from credit card chaos. In a time of sky-high tuition costs, many students fall to the temptation of easily accessible credit cards. They are left with tremendous amounts of debt before their lives have even truly begun.

10 Credit card is not the criminal. However, there is a suspicion that credit card companies have provided students with access to debt because they allow young, ignorant consumers without sufficient funds to undertake financial responsibility. To remedy this situation, the screening procedures must become more severe, and college campuses should be free of credit card marketers. If this does not change, many students, like myself, will suffer the consequences of the illusion of a seemingly free but staggeringly expensive \$3,000 dictionary.

When enough is enough?

1 Recently, I rushed into a clothing store to buy a pair of jeans. A salesperson asked if she could help. "I want a pair of jeans – 32-28," I said in haste.

2 "Do you want slim fit, easy fit, relaxed fit, baggy, or extra baggy?" she ventured. "Do you want stone-washed, acid-washed, button-fly or regular-fly, faded or regular?"

3 I stopped. I didn't have a hint, not the remotest idea of what she had asked, so I said, "I just want regular jeans. You know – the kind that used to be the only kind."

4 She pointed in the right direction. The trouble was, with all those options distributed in front of me, I wasn't sure what I wanted. So, I tried on pair after pair of jeans for almost two hours – trying to decide. It wasn't a big decision and little depended on my choice, but I was convinced that one pair had to be just right for me.

5 The jeans I chose were fine, but this simple transaction provoked a strong reaction in me. Buying a new pair of pants shouldn't render someone a wreck! Purchasing jeans was once an easy choice; now it's become a complex decision.

6 Choices in modern life have increased tremendously. A typical store in 1900 had only a few dozen categories with one or two options per category. Modern supermarkets have 50,000 to 60,000 items in thousands of categories. Looking for hair-care products? There are more than 350 types of shampoo and conditioners. Need a painkiller? There are almost 100 options. Toothpaste, anyone? You have 40+ types to choose from!

7 It's true that enforced restrictions with very limited or no choices make life dull, and having options does increase our sense of liberation and control. However, my jeans purchase highlights a different problem. As options increase out of control, people often begin to feel their life is falling apart. They are overloaded, overwhelmed and feel their

life growing vacant, without meaning.

8 We all rely on common sense to guide us, and the implication is that increasing choice should always increase happiness. Surprisingly, the opposite is true. Scientists verify that an overabundance of choice tends to bring a subtraction in well-being and happiness.

9 The measure of happiness in many countries has been going downhill. Of course, no one believes that a single factor explains this, but accumulating evidence from psychological research indicates that the explosion of choices and tremendous increases in material possessions play a primary role.

10 Increasing expectations seem to be part of the problem. The penetrating message of modern times seems to be: "The more we control our own fate, the more we expect to control it. The more we have, the more we want to have!" We expect to be able to have a life that is fulfilling, exciting, and prosperous! We transfer our high expectations to our property, our residences, and our families – expecting them to be outstanding and beautiful.

11 Some people believe they should never have to settle for material possessions that are just "good enough". Their trademark is that they expect and accept only the best. Researchers call this group "maximizers". Their thoughts are dominated by an ever-increasing desire for more and a focus on the highest quality. Studies show that maximizers are less optimistic and more depressed about their lives than others who are willing to settle for slightly less.

12 I have a friend who makes going out to dinner a nightmare. He struggles to select a dish, going in a circular motion between one option and another, trying to find the best

option. Some students behave the same way when looking for jobs, as they worry excessively about which job option to choose lest they overlook the "perfect" job!

13 We are told we're in the "driver's seat", when it comes to organizing and planning our lives. If we fail, it's our own fault and we can only accuse ourselves. However, it is unhealthy to combine overwhelming expectations and options, plus a tendency to blame ourselves for failures.

14 The success of 21st-century life turns out to be a bitter-sweet controversy and paradox. People have what they say they want. They're floating in a vast ocean of choices and material goods but finding they're still unfulfilled. Enough is never enough.

15 Let's pause and angle a bright light from the past into our modern times. Over 2,000 years ago, the famous Chinese philosopher Laozi prescribed, "Be content with whatsoever you have; rejoice in the way things are. When you realize there is nothing lacking, the whole world belongs to you." And he added this precaution: "He who knows that enough is enough will always have enough."

16 Use your college years to stir your heart and renew your life. Withstand the pressure of too many choices to acquire more than you need. Specify what truly matters to you and what does not. Learn when enough is enough, and you will trace a path of contentment throughout your life.

Listening Comprehension

Unit 1

News report 1

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. When people learn with their preferred learning styles.

- B. When people resist distracting noises in the environment.
C. When people see objects before hearing their descriptions.
D. When people focus on learning in inconsistent environments.
2. A. To learn the names of three fictional characters.
B. To find inconsistencies between two learning methods.
C. To label objects with the names they heard in the study.
D. To identify confusing information from what they were given.
3. A. Story writing. B. Image designing.
C. Character description. D. Foreign language learning.

News report 2

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. He received perfect scores in four exams.
B. He traveled to many places despite his mobility issues.
C. He took good care of his wife, who just had an operation.
D. He obtained his driver's license at 86 after just one year of training.
2. A. To be lifelong learners. B. To succeed in their careers.
C. To take on more challenges. D. To remain competitive in society.

Conversation

Directions: Listen to the conversation and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. She comes late to class from time to time.
B. She impresses the man with her performance.
C. She has no difficulty finishing the assignments.
D. She often fails to turn in her homework on time.
2. A. It presents great difficulty for her.
B. It makes her lose interest in French.
C. It enables her to help her father in business.
D. It improves her performance in other subjects.
3. A. He dislikes giving advice to his students.
B. He thinks the woman has a gift for French.
C. He scolds the woman for challenging his authority.
D. He has a good personal relationship with the woman.
4. A. Engage in creative activities. B. Try her best to please her father.

C. Work harder in her French class.

D. Exercise to strengthen her muscles.

Passage

Directions: Listen to the passage and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. She worked ahead of schedule and skipped a level.
B. She enjoyed the traditional method of learning Spanish.
C. She felt discouraged while studying after skipping a level.
D. She showed dissatisfaction with the slow pace of her class.
2. A. She had to learn with a teacher she didn't like.
B. She failed to pass the test required to skip a level.
C. She had to study sentence structures and grammar.
D. She had to learn the material that she already knew.
3. A. It aroused in her a strong interest in Spanish culture.
B. It excluded the use of other languages in the classroom.
C. It proved to be an unbalanced way to learn the language.
D. It explored the cultural and language elements in great depth.
4. A. She worked as an interpreter in a company.
B. She acted as a tourist guide on a trip to Mexico.
C. She taught Spanish speakers how to speak English.
D. She volunteered to work in a Spanish charity group.

Unit 2

News report 1

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. To make Berlin Europe's most popular tourist destination.
B. To help reduce traffic problems in the B traffic zone of Berlin.
C. To expand the city center to include the nine districts in Berlin's B zone.
D. To move tourists away from the well-known attractions in the city center.
2. A. Surf or kayak.
B. Cook wild herbs.
C. Try brewing beer.
D. Watch migratory birds.
3. A. It runs the risk of creating massive queues.
B. It attracts more tourists to city center attractions.
C. It exposes more cultural activities to larger audiences.
D. It arouses visitors' interest in niche activities the city offers.

News report 2

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. Force motorcyclists to wear helmets.
B. Prohibit tourists from hiring motorcycles.
C. Implement stricter traffic rules on the island.
D. Require valid paperwork from motorcyclists.
2. A. Several fatal traffic accidents were reported.
B. A local driver was arrested for colliding with a tourist.
C. A tourist was caught for drunk riding on his motorcycle.
D. Several tourists were hospitalized for riding motorcycles recklessly.
3. A. Its details will soon be determined.
B. There is concern about its impact on tourism.
C. It will reduce the number of motorcycles on the island.
D. It will lessen unlawful or disrespectful behavior on the road.

Conversation

Directions: Listen to the conversation and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. Many plants are sick because of the lack of sunlight.
B. There are so many plants that it is hard to see the sky.
C. The plants struggle hard to reach the sun or the sky above.
D. The plants are more spectacular than she has ever dreamed.
2. A. They enjoy being so far away from technology.
B. They live miles and miles away from each other.
C. They never travel more than 15 miles along the river.
D. They are separated from the world outside of the jungle.
3. **A. Emily gave her an empty bottle.** B. Emily gave her a bottle of water.
C. Emily helped her win a big prize. D. Emily showed her a great treasure.
4. **A. Small and common things should also be valued.**
B. Local people in the rainforest are easier to please.
C. Life can be quite difficult without modern technology.
D. Local people in the rainforest take their own lives for granted.

Passage

Directions: Listen to the passage and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. They can gain a real experience of nature.
B. They may be more distant from actual nature.
C. They will know how distant they are truly from nature.
D. They can get to know the real meaning of nature experiences.
2. A. Nature is very far away from them.
B. Nature is too mysterious to understand.
C. The nature in their parks and gardens is not precious.
D. The trees and flowers in their backyards are also part of nature.
3. A. Children should learn a lot of knowledge about nature.
B. Parks and gardens are good places to experience nature.
C. Nature programs are good for adults but not good for children.
D. Real nature experiences come from physical contact with nature.

Unit 3

News report 1

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. Having frequent physical activity in middle age.
B. Having physical activity at specific sensitive periods.
C. Having regular leisure-time physical activity at any age.
D. Having a consistent exercise routine throughout adulthood.
2. A. Report physical activity and take cognitive tests at five time points.
B. Report physical activity at five time points and take cognitive tests at 69.
C. Take various cognitive tests frequently to improve cognitive performance.
D. Remain physically active at specific sensitive periods during the experiment.

News report 2

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. Combining food with games.
B. Playing games in virtual reality bars.
C. Reinvented versions of classic games.
D. Fun and immersive social experiences.
2. A. Millennials and Generation Z will be the drivers behind this trend.
B. People will spend more on experiences rather than on commodities.

- C. A quarter of people will participate in competitive socializing activities.
D. Competitive socializing will remain popular despite economic uncertainty.
3. A. Valuable prizes. B. High-quality service.
C. Reinvented classic games. **D. In-person social interaction.**

Conversation

Directions: Listen to the conversation and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. **A. They are likely to dress like people in the 1960s.**
B. They are big fans of famous actresses in the 1960s.
C. They are inspired by the entertainment of the 1960s.
D. They like the lifestyle at the beginning of the 1960s.
2. **A. They are brightly colored.**
B. They are served on bright green leaves.
C. They are noodles for aliens in 1960s movies.
D. They are a type of noodles popular in the 1960s.
3. A. They will dance together. **B. They will have a singing contest.**
C. They will watch some classic movies. D. They will play movie-guessing games.
4. **A. Her roommate is a big fan of 1960s movies.**
B. Her roommate has cool clothes from the 1960s.
C. Her roommate has fantastic ideas for the party.
D. The more people at the party, the merrier they will be.

Passage

Directions: Listen to the passage and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. He watches TV in the evenings. **B. He will soon graduate from school.**
C. He usually goes shopping on weekends. D. He spends eight hours at school on weekdays.
2. A. Going canoeing with his family. B. Going downtown with his family.
C. Going with his friends to his cottage. **D. Going for long walks in the countryside.**
3. A. Racing their canoes. **B. Rowing down the river.**
C. Having swimming races. D. Exploring spots along the river.
4. **A. Cooking potatoes in the hot ashes.** B. Singing songs around the campfire.
C. Cooking sausages over the campfire. D. Spending the evening talking with friends.

Unit 4

News report 1

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. **A. Most building materials end up in a landfill after being used once.**
B. New buildings will consume about 5 percent of the world's raw materials.
C. Most building materials will reach the end of their life after 30 years.
D. New buildings account for 15 percent of the world's greenhouse gas emissions.
2. **A. Design new structures that can be easily taken apart.**
B. Require constructors to use materials that can be reused.
C. Call on city governments to pass laws to recycle materials.
D. Work hard to find ways to extend the life of building materials.
3. A. New mindsets of constructors. **B. New ways to look at ownership.**
C. New and sustainable raw materials. D. New laws about recycling building materials.

News report 2

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. **A. It will be a vertical city stretching over 106 miles.**
B. It will be a one-building city 200 meters above sea level.
C. It will be a city spanning 64 square kilometers in the desert.
D. It will be a 400-meter-wide building housing 9 million people.
2. A. The design of transport lines is very detailed.
B. Public transportation will partly rely on green energy.
C. Only zero-emission cars are allowed to run in the city.
D. High-speed rail will connect different sections of the city.
3. A. Earn millions of dollars as a travel hotspot.
B. Attract more visitors from its Gulf neighbors.
C. Make great contributions to the local economy.
D. Help it beat its Gulf neighbors in economic growth.

Conversation

Directions: Listen to the conversation and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. **A. Move to Santa Fe.** B. Have a trip to Santa Fe.
C. Get a new job in Santa Fe. D. Visit her husband in Santa Fe.

2. A. It would be dull. B. It would be unique.
C. It would be stressful. D. It would be amazing.
3. A. Its history. B. Its nightlife.
C. Its restaurants. D. Its coffee shops.
4. A. Its beautiful shops. B. Its colorful scenery.
C. Its unique architecture. D. Its various art galleries.

Passage

Directions: Listen to the passage and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. To introduce a good example of the cities of the future.
B. To demonstrate how to upgrade a city into a smart city.
C. To explain how to design a sustainable city in the desert.
D. To illustrate the importance of building carbon-free cities.
2. A. It uses traffic data to reduce accidents.
B. It joins services to improve the living environment.
C. It expands its bus network to relieve traffic congestion.
D. It utilizes technology to make cities greener and more efficient.
3. A. To allow the PRT to run six meters under street level.
B. To make the entire city car-free and friendly to pedestrians.
C. To ensure the functioning of the network of electric driverless cars.
D. To give digital plumbers easy access to the system that runs the city.

Unit 5

News report 1

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. Changes in traditional energy companies.
B. Employment in the clean energy industry.
C. The fastest-growing occupations in the U. S.
D. The outlook of the clean energy industry in the U. S.
2. A. The solar energy industry offers 12. 7 million jobs around the world.
B. New clean energy projects create 4. 3 million jobs in other industries.
C. Solar energy takes the lead in providing jobs in the renewable energy industry.
D. The renewable energy industry employs workers from traditional energy companies.
3. A. Jobs related to clean energy will be among the fastest-growing ones.
B. Sixteen million new jobs related to clean energy will soon be created.

- C. There will be a greater need for jobs related to clean energy after 2031.
- D. Fourteen million workers will switch to new jobs related to clean energy.

News report 2

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

- 1. **A. Tuition assistance.** B. Long-term well-being.
C. Salary raises or bonuses. D. Professional development.
- 2. A. To update employees' professional knowledge.
B. To urge employees to get professional certificates.
C. To encourage employees to obtain college degrees.
D. To improve recruitment and retention of employees.
- 3. **A. Paying for white-collar workers' graduate studies.**
B. Paying for the higher education of front-line workers.
C. Paying for the college education of employees' spouses.
D. Paying for the professional training of front-line workers.

Conversation

Directions: Listen to the conversation and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

- 1. A. She plans to do a part-time fast-food job.
B. She does not know where to start for her job.
C. She plans to find an internship after this semester.
D. She is scared by the idea of taking a part-time job.
- 2. **A. Seek help from the Career Center.**
B. Quit her job at the fast-food restaurant.
C. Review her résumé carefully by herself.
D. Try to get an internship at an international company.
- 3. A. He went to the Student Union. B. He went over to the Career Center.
C. He got information from the Internet. D. He sent his résumé to a few companies.
- 4. A. A job offer. **B. A good plan.**
C. An internship. D. Career information.

Passage

Directions: Listen to the passage and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. Salary tops the list of those factors that you should consider.
B. You should refuse the job offer if you find the salary insulting.
C. Salary is more important than benefits and working environment.
D. You should consider negotiating the salary if it is not what you expected.
2. A. Whether the job requires working overtime.
B. Whether the job allows flexible working hours.
C. Whether the job has an irregular work schedule.
D. Whether the job requires hours beyond your norm.
3. **A. Take the time to thoroughly consider the job offer.**
B. Give it a try and leave the job if it doesn't work out.
C. Accept it if most other people believe it to be a perfect job.
D. Seek advice from experts to find an excellent match for you.

Unit 6

News report 1

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. The circumstances in which AI can be used in education.
B. The impact of widespread AI use on education and society.
C. The opinions of university students regarding the use of AI.
D. The changes in attitudes of higher education regarding the use of AI.
2. A. Equal access to AI tools.
B. Guidelines on trustworthy AI tools for research.
C. Guidance on how to make the best use of AI tools.
D. Permission to use AI tools for finishing assignments.
3. A. Reliance on AI may lead to lack of human interaction in learning.
B. Schools taking different approaches to AI may widen inequalities.
C. The use of AI in education may hinder their critical thinking ability.
D. Engagement with AI may reduce their productivity in academic work.

News report 2

Directions: Listen to the news report and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. **A. To reduce health risks.**
C. To improve work efficiency.
- B. To minimize human error.
D. To avoid repetitive work for humans.

2. **A. Pick recyclable items out of garbage.**
B. Classify containers according to sizes.
C. Separate poisonous waste from other waste.
D. Place dry waste and wet waste in their respective bins.
3. A. They work four times as fast as humans.
B. They increase the quality of material output.
C. They triple the resale value of recyclable items.
D. They sort recyclable items more accurately than humans.

Conversation

Directions: Listen to the conversation and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

1. A. He told his grandmother funny stories.
B. He cleaned up his grandmother's apartment.
C. He helped his grandmother move to Washington D. C.
D. He taught his grandmother how to use electronic gadgets.
2. A. She was afraid of learning anything new.
B. It took her a long time to learn how to email.
C. She forgot to attach documents to her emails.
D. She didn't know how to open and close emails.
3. A. She refuses to have any new electronic gadgets.
B. She has difficulty adapting to life in this new city.
C. She suffers from depression after her husband passed away.
D. She is not interested in learning how to use electronic items.
4. A. Get her easy and fun PC golf games.
B. Download tennis games on her computer.
C. Spend time playing PC tennis games with her.
D. Buy her video games made for elderly people.

Passage

Directions: Listen to the passage and choose the best answer to each question you hear.

- | | |
|-----------------------|------------------------------|
| 1. A. Virtual images. | B. Virtual pastimes. |
| C. Online shopping. | D. Window shopping. |
| 2. A. News websites. | B. Music websites. |
| C. Travel websites. | D. Shopping websites. |

3. A. Women tend to spend more time wilfing on the Internet than men.
B. Women feel that wilfing damages the relationship with their families.
C. People under 25 were more likely to wilf than those aged 55 and above.
D. People between 25 and 55 are three times less likely to wilf than other age groups.

Directions: Translate the following paragraph into English.

Passage 1

中国书法（calligraphy）是一门独特的艺术，是世界上独一无二的艺术瑰宝。中国书法艺术的形成、发展与汉文字的产生与演进存在着密不可分的关系。汉字在漫长的演变发展过程中，一方面起着交流思想、继承文化的重要作用，另一方面它本身又形成了一种独特的艺术。书法能够通过作品把书法家个人的生活感受、学识、修养、个性等折射出来，所以，通常有“字如其人”的说法。中国书法不仅是中华民族的文化瑰宝，而且在世界文化艺术宝库中独放异彩。

Chinese calligraphy is a unique art and a unique art treasure in the world. The formation and development of Chinese calligraphy are closely related to the emergence and evolution of Chinese characters. In this long evolutionary process, Chinese characters have not only played an important role in exchanging ideas and transmitting culture but also developed into a unique art form. Calligraphic works well reflect calligraphers' personal feelings, knowledge, self-cultivation, personality, and so forth; thus, there is an expression that "Seeing the calligrapher's handwriting is like seeing the person." As one of the treasures of Chinese culture, Chinese calligraphy shines splendidly in the world's treasure house of culture and art.

Passage 2

中国是一个以其悠久的历史 and 多彩的文化而闻名于世的国家。如果你渴望更深入地了解这个伟大的国家，你或许会对中国研究课程感兴趣。参加这门课程将有机会学习中国的传统和历史，同时培养与中文使用者自如交流所必需的语言技能。参与者还将掌握中国相关职业和中国研究技巧的知识。对于高级课程，还会有关于中文（含文言文）学术写作技巧的指导，这对于理解中国传统尤为重要。

China is a country known for its rich history and fascinating culture. If you're keen to gain a deeper understanding of this great nation, you may be interested in the Chinese studies program. Enrolling in this program provides an opportunity to learn about China's traditions and history while also developing language skills essential for confident communication with Chinese speakers. Participants will also acquire knowledge of China-related professions and research techniques in Chinese studies. With regard to the advanced-level courses, there are instructions on academic writing skills in Chinese, including classical Chinese, which is important for understanding Chinese tradition.

Passage 3

出生于 20 世纪 90 年代末至 21 世纪初的中国 Z 世代预计将在未来几年推动中国的消费增长。因此，对于消费品公司来说，如果他们想在迅速增长的中国市场取得成功，了解这一代人就显得至关重要。

不同的环境和时代定义了当今的 Z 世代。与前几代相比，中国的 Z 世代是在国家历史性经济扩张的高峰期长大的，因此习惯于生活水平的迅速提高。此外，他们习惯通过互联网来认识世界。作为真正的数字原住民，他们本能地熟悉技术在通信、娱乐和商业中的作用。

Born between the late 1990s and early 2000s, Gen Z in China is expected to drive the country's consumption growth in the coming years. So, it is crucial for consumer goods companies to understand this generation if they want to succeed in the fast-growing Chinese market.

A different environment and era define today's Gen Z. Compared with previous generations, Gen Z in China spent their childhoods during the peak period of the country's historic economic expansion and are consequently used to rapid improvements in their standard of living. Additionally, they are the ones who don't know a world without the Internet. As true digital natives, they possess an instinctive familiarity with technology's role in communication, entertainment, and commerce.

Passage 4

黄文秀于 1989 年出生在靠近越南边境的百色市。她家庭贫困，家中所谓的“沙发”是由轮胎和木板（plank）制成的。尽管生活困难，黄文秀仍然通过自己的努力在 2016 年获得了北京师范大学的硕士学位。她本可以在大城市找到一份高薪工作，但她选择返回百色，帮助家乡脱贫致富。2018 年，黄文秀帮助 88 户、418 人脱贫，将贫困率从 22.88% 降低到了 2.71%。村级集体经济收入也达到了 6 万元以上，比上年翻了一番。

Huang Wenxiu was born in Baise, a city close to the border with Vietnam, in 1989. Her family was so poor that their "sofa" was made of tires and wooden planks. Despite financial struggles, Huang worked hard and earned a master's degree from Beijing Normal University in 2016. Although she could have landed a high-paying job in a big city, Huang returned to Baise to help her community overcome poverty and become prosperous. In 2018, Huang lifted a total of 418 people from poverty in 88 households, reducing the poverty rate from 22.88% to 2.71%. The village-level collective economic income also reached over 60,000 yuan, doubling the previous year's income.

Passage 5

中国人很早就有了存钱的概念，且一直看重这一观念。中国的家庭储蓄率位居世界前列。在相对富足的社会中成长的中国青年已经摆脱了消费主义的控制，花起钱来更趋于理性。这种向理智消费的转变有助于创造更健康、更积极的社会氛围，同时也能减少蓬勃发展的消费主义对环境造成的浪费和破坏。

存钱的习惯本身就很有教育意义。但除此之外，把储蓄花在真正值得的地方以及用它来帮助人们实现生活目标更是值得推崇的。因此，我们除了要养成省钱的好习惯外，也得学会如何明智地花钱。

The Chinese have long established and valued the idea of saving. The household savings rate in China is among the highest in the world. The younger generation in China, who have grown up in a relatively prosperous and abundant society, have learned

to cast off their addiction to consumerism and are spending money more sensibly. This shift toward spending wisely helps create a healthier and more positive social atmosphere while reducing the waste and damage to the environment caused by booming consumerism.

The habit of saving itself is of great educational value. On top of that, spending savings where they truly deserve and using them to realize one's life objectives are commendable. Therefore, learning how to spend wisely is also indispensable in addition to getting into the good habit of saving money.

Passage 6

在北京 2022 冬奥会的开幕式上，当“雪花”中的微火缓缓升空时，每个人都想知道以往常见的“大火”在哪里。而奥运会开幕式的导演表示，以微火取代熊熊燃烧的大火，传递了低碳、环保的理念，实现了奥运历史上的一次点火（ignition）创新。不仅如此，他还表示，中国传统哲学讲究意境，讲究通过细节看世界。所以，我们也完全可以把这一次的点火看作是“一叶知秋”。火苗虽小，但我们能从中看到伟大的奥林匹克精神，看到全人类的激情与浪漫。

When the snowflake-shaped structure, with a small flame in the middle, was lifted into the air at the Beijing 2022 Winter Olympics opening ceremony, everyone was left wondering where the usual big fire was. The director of the opening ceremony explained that replacing the big fire with a small flame conveys low-carbon, environmental-friendly ideas, which was an innovation in Olympic history. Besides, he pointed out that traditional Chinese philosophy stresses artistic conception and the idea of seeing the world from a tiny detail. So, the torch ignition this time can be perfectly described as "knowing autumn comes by one leaf". Although the flame was small, it embodied the great Olympic spirit and the passion and romance of all humanity.